Decision Memo: A 12-Month Pilot of an AI Policy-Intelligence Capability for Bangladesh

For the consideration of: the ICT Division; for information the Planning Commission, Finance Division, Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division, BBS and a2i · **From:** Md Naim Hassan Saykat, author of the BAPIL Technical Blueprint · **Date:** October 2026

Basis: BAPIL Technical Blueprint, Version 1.0 (DOI pending; https://github.com/md-naim-hassan-saykat/bapil). This memo is a separate document, not part of the Blueprint.

Status. An independent research proposal, not an official document. No authority has decided anything on BAPIL; no body, host or funding exists.

Purpose and why now. To propose six decisions that would start, after a preparatory Phase 0, a small, safe and open pilot of an AI tool that helps officials find and cite official evidence in Bangla and English. Drafting of a national AI policy is to begin in the fourth quarter of 2026 [1], after a revised draft of February 2026 [2]; the Personal Data Protection Act, 2026 and the National Data Management Act, 2026 now frame public-sector data use [3, 4]; and official documents remain scattered, often as scanned Bangla PDFs.

Proposal. A university-anchored lab under an MoU with the ICT Division, with a Steering Board and an independent Ethics and Risk Review Committee (ERRC) whose veto binds the host as far as its statutes and the host agreement allow. Year 1 delivers **P1**, a bilingual search tool that cites official sources or abstains, piloted with 30 or more analysts; **P2**, five years of budget allocations as open data; a 500-question open Bangla benchmark; training for 100 officials; and a public transparency register. *Safeguards:* published data first; no profiling of individuals; other personal data only with consent, a DPIA and ERRC approval; a person reviews every output; hosting in Bangladesh.

Decisions proposed (summarised from Blueprint Table 57; bodies and timings are proposals).

No.	Decision	Proposed responsible body	Proposed timing
D1	Accept the Blueprint as a technical input to national AI policy drafting	ICT Division	Q4 2026
D2	After Phase 0: approve the 12-month pilot, agree an MoU with the selected host and commit Year 1 funding (about Tk 4.7 crore)	ICT Division and host	End of Phase 0
D3	Authorise bulk access to already-public document collections; nominate data custodians	LPAD, Finance Division, Planning Commission, BBS, a2i	During Phase 0
D4	Nominate Steering Board members; select ERRC members by open call through an independent panel	ICT Division and host; independent panel	During Phase 0
D5	Fund Phase 0 (about Tk 0.44 crore, about six months): open host call, independent legal review, costing study, data-access confirmation; name a focal point	ICT Division or a development partner	Within 90 days
D6	Confirm guardrails: no deployment beyond class A without a G4 decision; no prohibited uses	Steering Board	At charter adoption

Sequence and resources. D1 and D5 come first; D2 only after Phase 0, so Month 1 can be July 2027. Indicative budget: about Tk 20.4 crore over 36 months (Tk 4.7 crore in Year 1; scenarios Tk 17.9 to 25.3 crore; adjusted Tk 22.2 crore), plus Tk 0.44 crore for Phase 0; about 9 full-time staff in Year 1, rising to 19. Planning estimates, not approved funding; the conditional scale-up (Annex W) is not requested.

Evidence required before D2. Legal review of the provisions of the 2026 laws in force (U1 to U3); the host's acceptance of the ERRC veto (U15); costing of omitted items (U16); reuse terms or bulk access (D3).

Month-12 targets (not results). P1 passes its gate (30 or more users, Recall@10 at least 0.85, citation precision at least 0.95, usefulness at least 4.0 of 5); 500 benchmark questions; five years of budget data; 100 officials trained.

Key risks. Data access (narrower corpus, assisted download); wrong answers (citations, abstention, human review); mission creep (charter prohibitions, independent veto); funding delay (only Phase 0 funded before D2).

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References

References are numbered in the order in which they are first cited, and only references cited in this document are listed.

[1] THE DAILY OBSERVER. Rehan Asif Asad outlines govt's five priorities for ICT, telecom[EB/OL]. Dhaka: The Daily Observer, 2026-08-10[2026-10-20]. Available: https://observerbd.com/news/587314

[2] AI POLICY FOR BANGLADESH (aipolicy.gov.bd). Bangladesh National AI Policy 2026-2030, Draft v2, February 9, 2026[EB/OL]. Dhaka, 2026-02-09[2026-10-22]. Available: https://aipolicy.gov.bd/docs/national-ai-policy-bangladesh-2026-2030-draft-v2.0.pdf

[3] GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF BANGLADESH. Personal Data Protection Act, 2026 (Act No. 63 of 2026)[S/OL]. Bangladesh Gazette, Extraordinary, 2026-04-10. Copy published by the ICT Division[2026-10-22]. Available: https://objectstorage.ap-dcc-gazipur-1.oraclecloud15.com/n/axvjbnqprylg/b/V2Ministry/o/office-ictd/2026/3/1c355c6a-cc9c-42a0-b07f-e0876b89dc9d.pdf

[4] GOVERNMENT OF THE PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF BANGLADESH. National Data Management Act, 2026 (Act No. 80 of 2026)[S/OL]. Bangladesh Gazette, Extraordinary, 2026-04-10. Copy published by the ICT Division[2026-10-22]. Available: https://objectstorage.ap-dcc-gazipur-1.oraclecloud15.com/n/axvjbnqprylg/b/V2Ministry/o/office-ictd/2026/3/ab68f686-1ba9-4c04-85ad-83f0982f7b4e.pdf